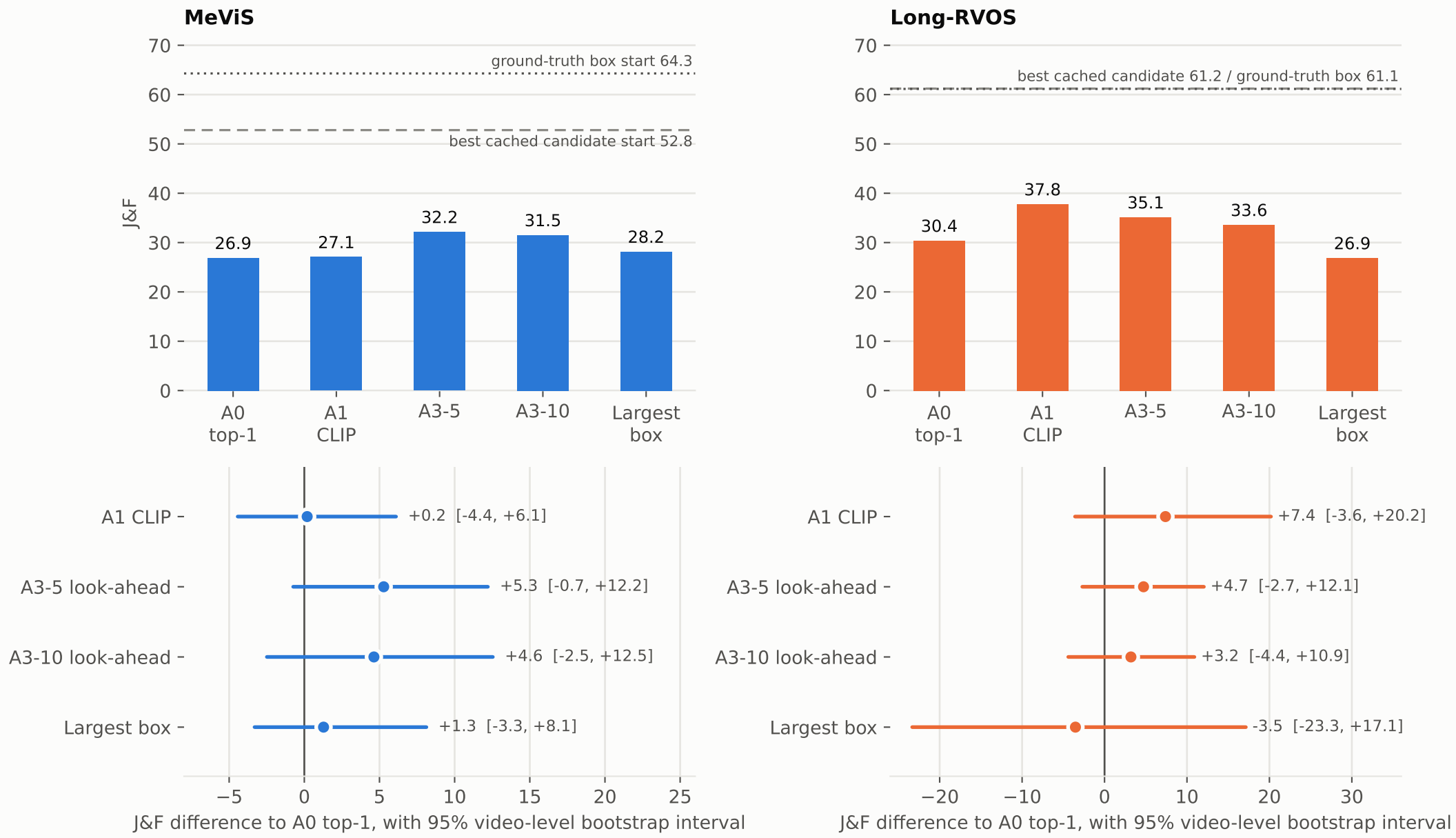
Candidate-selection arms: J&F, and the difference to the top-1 start



Dashed lines are oracle starts, a diagnostic ceiling only (not method performance). No arm's interval excludes zero on either dataset; no arm meets the Amendment 6 claim rule.
A3 = offline multi-frame look-ahead over N = 5 or 10 frames. The best arm flips with the dataset (A3-5 on MeViS, A1 on Long-RVOS).
Selected subsets, single runs; not official benchmark results. Sentences of one video are not independent.